IS212 (AY 2026/27, T1) – Managing Changes – A Guide

A change in Scrum is any new, revised, or corrected requirement that affects the Product Backlog, or planned work. Changes need to be managed so that the Scrum Team can assess their impact, maintain transparency and quality, and reprioritize work with the Product Owner, adapting to the evolving stakeholder and user needs.

1. Change Request / Change Description

- What is the requested change?
- Why is the change needed?
- Is it a new requirement, a clarification, or a correction of an existing requirement?

2. Product Backlog

- Add a new User Story/PBI if it is a new requirement
- Reprioritize incomplete User Stories
- Update existing backlog items if the requirement has been clarified

3. Acceptance Criteria

- Define or update the Acceptance Criteria for the changed/new requirement
- Check whether existing Acceptance Criteria are still valid
- Verify that all original Acceptance Criteria remain satisfied

4. Analyze Changes - Story Points

- Estimate the new User Stories
- Re-estimate an existing item only if new information materially changes the team's understanding of its size, complexity, effort, or uncertainty
- For an incomplete item, the team can estimate the **remaining work**

5. Software Design Documentation

- C4 Architecture Models
- Class Diagram
- Sequence Diagram
- Database/Data Model
- API/interface specifications, if applicable

6. Test Cases

SMU Classification: Restricted
SMU Classification: Restricted

- Unit Test Cases
- Functional Test Cases
- Integration Test Cases
- End-to-End (E2E) Test Cases
- Regression Test Cases

Changes to User Stories

These are some ways you can handle your user stories.

Scenario 1 — Original Acceptance Criterion was missed

US-01: As a user, I want to make a payment online so that I can have the convenience of having orders delivered. [Story Points: 5]

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC1: Pay by Visa
- AC2: Pay by Mastercard
- AC3: Display payment confirmation

US-01 was marked Done in Sprint 1 after the team believed that AC1, AC2, and AC3 were satisfied.

In Sprint 2, the team discovered that AC3 was actually not implemented.

Solution:

Reopen US-01 and return it to an incomplete state in Sprint 3. If only AC3 remains incomplete, the remaining work for AC3 can be estimated at 2 Story Points, for example. The team completes AC3 and verifies that all Acceptance Criteria and the Definition of Done are satisfied before marking US-01 Done again.

Note: AC3 was part of the original User Story. The team simply failed to implement it. Therefore, this is not a new requirement.

Scenario 2 — New requirement

US-01: As a user, I want to make a payment online so that I can have the convenience of having orders delivered. [Story Points: 5]

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC1: Pay by Visa
- AC2: Pay by Mastercard
- AC3: Display payment confirmation

US-01 was marked Done in Sprint 1 after the team believed that AC1, AC2, and AC3 were satisfied.

In Sprint 2, the team discovered that PayNow is now required as an additional form of online payment. PayNow was not part of the original requirements or Acceptance Criteria of US-01.

Solution:

SMU Classification: Restricted
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Keep US-01 as Done and create a new User Story:

US-25: As a user, I want to make a payment online via PayNow so that I can have the convenience of having orders delivered.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC1: Pay by PayNow
- AC2: Display payment confirmation for PayNow

Story Points: Estimate story points for US-25

Scenario 3 — New requirement + original Acceptance Criterion is incorrect

US-01: As a user, I want to make a payment online so that I can have the convenience of having orders delivered. [Story Points: 5]

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC1: Pay by Visa
- AC2: Pay by Mastercard
- AC3: Display payment confirmation

US-01 was marked Done in Sprint 1 after the team believed that AC1, AC2, and AC3 were satisfied.

In Sprint 2, the team discovered two issues:

1. PayNow is now required as an additional form of online payment. PayNow was not part of the original requirements of US-01.
2. The implementation of AC3 does not actually satisfy the original Acceptance Criterion because the payment confirmation is incorrect due to a bug

Solution:

1. Create a new User Story for PayNow

US-25: As a user, I want to make a payment online via PayNow so that I can have the convenience of having orders delivered.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC1: Pay by PayNow
- AC2: Display payment confirmation for PayNow

Story Points: Estimate story points for US-25.

2. Address the problem with US-01

Reopen US-01 and return it to an incomplete state in Sprint 3. The team corrects the implementation of AC3 and verifies that all Acceptance Criteria and the Definition of Done are satisfied before marking US-01 Done again.

If only AC3 requires correction, the remaining work can be estimated at 2 Story Points, for example.